

Philosophy Statement

My perspective on education has been shaped by a diverse range of experiences across different educational systems. Growing up in the Soviet Union's rigid, memorization-focused environment, I learned the importance of structure and discipline. However, I also became acutely aware of the limitations of a system that left little room for creativity or personal expression. Students were not encouraged to share their opinions or challenge teachers, and independent thinking was often discouraged. This experience left me yearning for an educational environment where students could express their ideas, emotions, and perspectives freely and without fear.

As an educator today, I constantly reflect on how to create such an environment. How can I build a classroom where students feel safe expressing themselves and where their voices are genuinely heard? This question has become central to my teaching practice.

My educational journey at **Eskişehir Osmangazi University in Turkey** marked a transformative turning point in my philosophy of teaching and learning. For the first time, I experienced a truly student-centered educational system. Professors encouraged open dialogue, welcomed questions, and treated students as partners in the learning process. Students were able to openly share ideas, discuss different perspectives, and communicate freely with their instructors—an experience that was unimaginable in my home country. One moment that left a lasting impression on me was the opportunity to sit in the university cafeteria, drinking tea and engaging in informal conversations with my professors. These simple yet meaningful interactions broke down hierarchical barriers and reinforced the idea that learning extends beyond the classroom walls.

I was especially inspired by **Prof. Dr. Nihan Hacıömeroğlu** and **Doç. Dr. Kader Reyhan**, who played a crucial role in shaping my confidence and academic identity. They often reminded us that *“learning begins when you dare to ask questions”* and that *“your voice matters as much as the content you study.”* Their encouragement helped me believe in my own ideas and see myself not only as a student, but as a future educator. Observing how they modeled respect, empathy, and critical thinking made me think for the first time, *“One day, I want to be a professor too.”* Their passion and dedication continue to guide my teaching philosophy.

Later, while teaching in Turkey, I experienced firsthand the power of collaboration and teamwork in the classroom. Students worked together to solve problems, exchange ideas, and learn from one another, reinforcing my belief that learning becomes deeper and more meaningful when students are active participants rather than passive recipients of information.

When I later arrived in the United States, I was introduced to student-centered instructional methods such as small-group instruction and classroom centers. These approaches allowed for individualized attention, differentiated instruction, and active engagement for learners with diverse needs. My experiences in both Turkey and the United States helped me understand that education should focus not only on academic achievement but also on the development of the whole child—socially, emotionally, and intellectually.

Inclusion is another essential component of my teaching philosophy, particularly for students with Individualized Education Plans (IEPs). In Crimea, children with special needs were often excluded from mainstream education and marginalized within society. Witnessing this deeply influenced my commitment to inclusive education. I strive to create a classroom where every child, regardless of ability, feels valued, supported, and capable of success. All students deserve access to the resources, encouragement, and understanding necessary to thrive.

My goal as an educator is to foster a learning environment that encourages curiosity, creativity, and independent thinking while also providing the structure and support students need to succeed. I want every student to feel safe expressing their thoughts and emotions, knowing they are respected and heard. Ultimately, I hope my students leave my classroom with confidence in their ability to communicate, think critically, and contribute meaningfully to society.

I would like to conclude my teaching philosophy with a quote by Ban Ki-moon:

“Education is a right, not a privilege, and it should be available to all children, regardless of their background or circumstances.”

Student Teaching Profile

Date: 02-22-2025

Teacher Candidate Information

First and Last Name: Safiie Seitaptiieva

Street Address: 999 41st Ave NE

City, State, Zip: Columbia Heights, MN, 55421

Hamline Email: sseitaptiieva01@hamline.edu

Home Email: safieseytaptieva@gmail.com

Phone Number: 6517959204

Advisor: Mike Noreen

Student Teaching Semester: Fall 2025

Licensure Area: Elementary K-5

GPA: 3.42

Field Experience Record

Course Name	School District	School	Hours On-site	Semester	Grade Level	Subject
GED 7867 Theory to Practice	Mounds View Public Schools	Chippewa Middle School	35 days	Spring 2024	6th	Earth Science
GED 7872 Exceptionality	St. Paul Public Schools	Murray Middle School	5 hours	Winter 2024	6th-8th	Special Education

Education and Content Courses

University	Grade Received	Credit Hours	Course Title	Course Number
Hamline University	A-	4	Educational Psychology	GED 7825
Hamline University	B-	4	Schools and Society	GED 7815
Hamline University	P	0	Intro to Advanced Teacher Thinking	GED 7801
Hamline University	B	4	Theory to Practice	

				GED 7867
Hamline University	A	4	Education and Cultural Diversity	GED 7862
Hamline University	A	2	Exceptionality	GED 7872
Hamline University	A	4	Teaching Science in the Elementary School	GED 7851
Hamline University	A	1	Teaching Physical Education in the Elementary School K-6	GED 7838
Hamline University	A	1	Teaching Health in the Elementary School K-6	GED 7837
Hamline University	A	2	Teaching the Arts in the Elementary School K-6	GED 7834
Hamline University	HP	2	Teaching Mathematics in the Elementary School	GED 7852L - Lab:
Hamline University	B-	6	Teaching Mathematics in the Elementary School	GED 7852
Hamline University	P	0	Preparing to Student Teach: Advising and Reflection	GED 7802
Hamline University	C	2	English Learners in the Mainstream	GED 7888
Hamline University	B+	4	Teaching Literacy in the Elementary School	GED 7846
Hamline University	P	2	Teaching Literacy in	GED 7846L -

			the Elementary School	Lab
Hamline University	B	2	Teaching Literacy in the Elementary School K-6, Part II	GED 7847
Hamline University	A	4	Teaching Social Studies in the Elementary School K-6	GED 7840
Hamline University	A-	4	Capstone Design	GED 8400
Hamline University	A-	2	GED 7050 - Student Teaching Seminar	GED 7050
Hamline University	A, Pass	6	Student Teaching Elementary K-6	GED 7885